

\$500 million dollar mistake, easy way to hack tech firms, creepy sales outreach and Rust going independent

News from the
developer community

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CITIBANK PAYS \$500 MILLION FOR A UI GLITCH

A shoddily designed UI of a financial software led to Citibank paying off \$500 million on behalf of a client who owed the huge loan. The funny



bit is that most of the debt wasn't due to be paid off until 2023. The financial software in question is called Flexcube and the UI is indeed very bad. So much that the transaction, which required three individuals to sign off on, went through at every vetting stage. The actual transaction was made by a subcontractor in India, whose work was supervised by his colleague in India and then a Citibank official in Delaware had to give the final approval. The actual transaction was supposed to be for just \$7.8 million which was interest owed to the creditors. Citibank notified the creditors that the payment had been made in mistake and some creditors did return the money but a large chunk of them decided to keep the principal payment. Citibank sued

to get the money back but the judge ruled against Citibank leaving it short of \$500 million.

RESEARCHER HACKS 35 TECH COMPANIES

And all it took was to create a similarly named package within a public npm repository. Researcher Alex Birsan managed to breach 35 major tech companies such as Microsoft, PayPal, Apple, Netflix, Tesla, Yelp, Shopify and Uber by using a rather innocuous method. Upon noticing that PayPal was using privately created npm packages, the researcher simply created packages with the same name and placed them in a public npm repository. Turns out that publicly stored packages got priority over the internal repository and the payload was successfully delivered to whomever was requesting said package. Birsan hunted down manifest files to figure out the names of privately created packages and created counterfeit packages which were then placed in public repository



ries such as npm, PyPI and Ruby-Gems. The counterfeit packages were harmless and used as a means of proving the concept. The haker made a healthy profit at the end of it all too, the researcher walked away with USD 130,000 in bug bounty rewards.

RUST FOUNDATION FORMED BY MOZILLA

Rust, the popular programming language developed by Mozilla employee Graydon Hoare, has branched out from Mozilla with its own foundation. Mozilla will continue to be



a Platinum Sponsor of the Rust Foundation and this also opens up opportunities for more companies to become stakeholders. Founding member companies include AWS, Huawei, Google, Microsoft and Mozilla. The move will provide Rust with financial commitments, dedicated focus from all the stakeholders and will help the language grow its community further. Interim Executive Director, Ashley Williams said, "This marks a huge step in the growth of Rust on several axes; not the least of which, a formal, financial commitment from a set of global industry leading companies, heralding Rust's arrival as an enterprise production-ready technology. I am personally moved, and motivated, by the sense of responsibility that comes from this commitment. Our founding sponsors' eager and enthusiastic participation is not only a promise to maintain and sustain Rust as what it is today, but an endorsement of Rust's values and a dedication to share the responsibility of cultivating the future that Rust aspires to."